

DARIO SHARIATIAN

dario.shariatian@inria.fr ◇ [GitHub: darioShar](#) ◇ [Personal Website](#) ◇ [Google Scholar](#)

Paris, France

PhD researcher in generative modeling, working on continuous and discrete diffusion methodology. First/Co-author work at ICLR, ICML, and NeurIPS; recent Sakana AI intern with experience in multi-node H200 experiments.

EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science, ENS Paris - PSL (INRIA), Paris Oct 2023 – 2026

- Advised by Alain Durmus and Umut Simsekli in the Sierra team led by Francis Bach.

MSc in Mathematics - Part C, University of Oxford 2022 – 2023

BSc/MSc in Applied Mathematics (Ingénieur Polytechnicien), École Polytechnique 2019 – 2022

Classes préparatoires, MPSI – MP*, Lycée Saint-Louis, Paris 2017 – 2019

French International Mathematical Olympiad (IMO) training program, Animaths 2016

- Selected for the final French IMO team training camp at Université de Montpellier; 40 students nationwide.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern at Sakana AI, with Dr. Stefano Peluchetti, Tokyo May – Oct 2025

- Developed and first-authored Latent-Augmented Discrete Diffusion Models, adding a learnable continuous latent channel to masked discrete diffusion for up to 2x faster categorical generation.
- Designed and ran multi-node H200 experiments for large-scale text/molecule-like categorical generation.
- Owned the research loop: method design, implementation, large-scale training, ablations, paper writing.
- Proposed and co-organized the first Sakana AI research retreat, a 5-day offsite with the research staff.

Research Visit at Università di Padova, with Prof. Giovanni Conforti Mar 2025

- Initiated a joint mathematics/physics project on diffusion-based generative models for cosmology, spanning problem formulation, collaboration setup, and early technical direction.

Quantitative Research Intern at Squarepoint Capital, with Dr. Asgeir Biriksson, London Mar – Aug 2022

- Developed predictive statistical models for mid-frequency equities; proposed a new machine learning approach shared across several teams.

Software Engineer Intern at Ledger, Paris Jun – Sep 2021

- Built a C emulator for the Ledger Nano X, accelerating debugging and internal development workflows.

PUBLICATIONS

Latent-Augmented Discrete Diffusion Models (LADD) May 2026

[Shariatian, D.](#), Durmus, A., Simsekli, U., & Peluchetti, S.

SPIGM Workshop @ ICML 2026. We introduce a learnable auxiliary latent channel for discrete diffusion, enabling cross-token modeling and improving few-step generation.

Uniform Diffusion Models Revisited May 2026

Gourevitch, S., Janati, Y., [Shariatian, D.](#), Simsekli, U., Moulines, É., Xing, E.P., & Durmus, A.

SPIGM Workshop @ ICML 2026. Leave-one-out denoising and absorbing-state reformulation for uniform diffusion, with parameterization conversions and improved sampling behavior, e.g., in language modeling.

Algorithm/Data-Dependent Generalization Bounds for Score-Based Models Sep 2025

[Shariatian, D.*](#), Dupuis, B.*, Haddouche, M.*, Durmus, A., & Simsekli, U.

NeurIPS 2025. Theory/empirics work establishing generalization bounds that account jointly for optimization dynamics and data distribution.

Bit-Level Discrete Diffusion with Markov Probabilistic Models Feb 2025

[Shariatian, D.*](#), Pham, L.T.N.*, Ocello, A., Conforti, G., & Durmus, A.

ICML 2025. Discrete diffusion for bit data, outperforming MD4 and Discrete Flow Matching on binarized MNIST with about 2.5x fewer network evaluations, alongside convergence theory.

Heavy-Tailed Diffusion with Denoising Lévy Probabilistic Models

Jan 2025

Shariatian, D., Simsekli, U., & Durmus, A.

ICLR 2025. Diffusion-model framework for heavy-tailed and imbalanced data.

Piecewise Deterministic Generative Models

Jul 2024

Bertazzi, A., **Shariatian, D.**, Simsekli, U., Moulines, É., & Durmus, A.

NeurIPS 2024. Generative modeling with piecewise-deterministic Markov processes, combining deterministic motion with random jumps for smoother dynamics.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Numerical Analysis, École Polytechnique

Mar – Jun 2024

- Teaching assistant for MAA106 Numerical Analysis.

Oral Examiner for MSc Data Science for Business/Finance, X-HEC

2024, 2025, 2026

- Oral examiner for machine-learning and data-science students in the joint École Polytechnique / HEC program.

ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENTS & OTHERS

MSc Mathematics with Distinction, University of Oxford

2023

BSc/MSc Applied Mathematics, Top 10%, École Polytechnique

2019-2022

- Ranked top of class in MAP553 Foundations of Machine Learning, MAP556 Monte Carlo Methods, MAP586 Modern C++ software design, and PHY430 Advanced Quantum Physics.

Classes Préparatoire MPSI / MP*, Lycée Saint-Louis

2017-2019

- Ranked 1/44 in first year and 2/42 in second year.

French National Mathematics Olympiad

2017

- Obtained a distinction in the Paris academy.

TALKS, SCHOOLS, AND SERVICE

Selected Talks

2024 – 2025

- NeurIPS@Paris (oral); Sakana AI; ENS Lyon; GDR IASIS / ENS Lyon; Califrais; Alan Turing Institute; Oberwolfach MFO.

Selected Workshops and Schools

2024 – 2026

- Alan Turing Institute / Isaac Newton Institute diffusion school; Oberwolfach Statistical Challenges for Deep Generative Models; MBZUAI ML Winter School on Representation Learning and GenAI.

Service

2024 – 2026

- Reviewer: ICML 2024, NeurIPS 2024, AAAI 2025, TMLR, ICLR 2025, ICML 2025, ICML 2026 Golden Reviewer
- Organizer: diffusion models reading group at INRIA Paris; Sakana AI research retreat.

SELECTED EARLIER PROJECTS AND SKILLS

An Alternative to the Log-Likelihood, MSc thesis, University of Oxford

Dec 2022 – Apr 2023

- Studied Sinkhorn EM as an entropic optimal transport alternative to maximum likelihood.

On-Board Computer for Nano-Satellite, IONSAT, École Polytechnique Space Center

2020 – 2021

- Led the team designing the OBC architecture in collaboration with CNES; presented at Dubai IAC 2021.

Programming: Python, C/C++, Qt, OpenGL. **ML stack:** PyTorch, PyTorch Lightning, Slurm, git, gdb. **Research strengths:** diffusion models, generative modeling, discrete generation, project ownership.